

1770

Slave trade

The slave trade reached its peak in the 18th century, with 80,000 slaves brought from West Africa to America every year.



1771

First modern factory

Richard Arkwright builds the water frame, a spinning machine that is powered by water wheels. His invention is quickly copied.

1775–1783

US independence

The United States approves the Declaration of Independence on July 4, 1776, breaking free from Britain. The new nation is made of 13 colonies.



1789–1799

French Revolution

People in Paris rebel. They overthrow their king and queen.

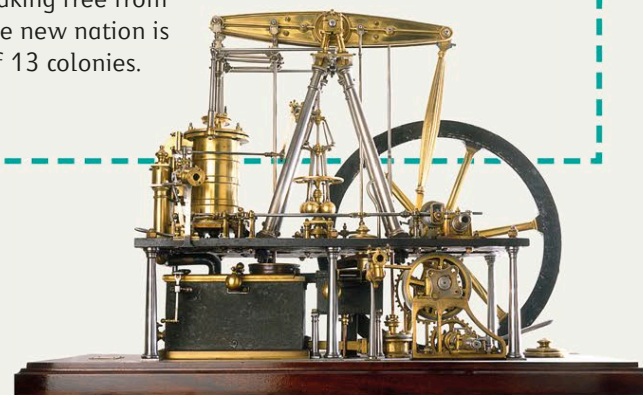


Vive La France!

1776

Steam engine

James Watt develops the first of his many steam engines and introduces the term "horsepower" to show how powerful his engines are.



Early steam engine

1803

Denmark bans slavery

Denmark is the first European country to ban slavery.

1811–1828

Independent Americas

Several American countries fight wars against their Spanish rulers, winning independence.

1821–1832

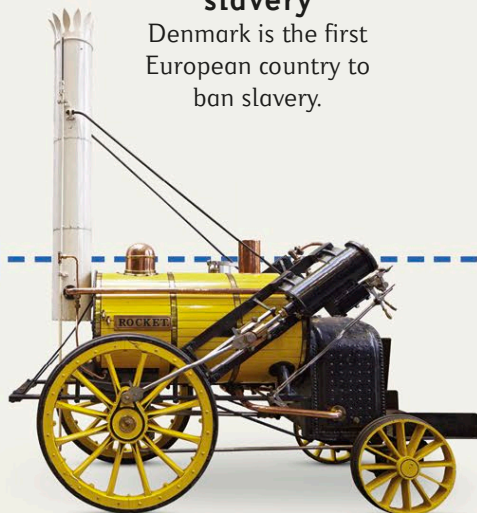
Greek War of Independence

Greece becomes independent, winning its freedom from the Ottoman Empire.

1831

First electrical motor

Michael Faraday, a British physicist and chemist, invents the first electric motor.



Stephenson's Rocket

1829

Prize-winning steam engine

George Stephenson designs the *Rocket*, which wins a competition to power the Liverpool & Manchester Railway.

1822

Brazilian independence

Brazil wins its independence from Portugal. Pedro I becomes the founder and first ruler of the empire of Brazil.

1876

Telephone invented

Alexander Graham Bell invents the first telephone. People are able to talk over long distances for the first time.



First telephone

1876

Internal combustion engine invented

Nikolaus Otto invents the combustion engine, which can be used to power cars, trucks, and motorcycles.

1893

Votes for women

New Zealand is the first country to give women equal voting rights. The next country to do so will be Australia, in 1903.

1904–1905

Russo-Japanese War

Japan defeats Russia with clever new tactics and weapons. Japan is seen as a world power for the first time.

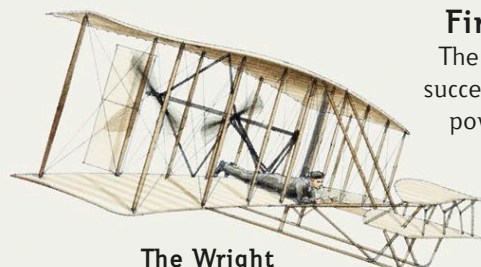


Communism grew in Russia after the Russo-Japanese War

1903

First airplane

The Wright brothers successfully fly the first powered airplane.



The Wright brothers' plane



Australian flag

1901

Australian independence

Australia becomes independent and is no longer under British rule.